

∩ C14 · CLOSENESS

The Language of Touch

The Science and Experience of Closeness

The Language of Touch

Mark the menu in private. Play only the overlap you both called welcome tonight.

1. Unseen, mark hand, shoulder, upper back, linked arms, knees, forearm, hair, face, and one nonsexual form you add: welcome tonight, not tonight, or leave out.
2. Play only the overlap. An added form needs a yes from both. No overlap: describe a future welcome, and do not demonstrate it.
3. Before contact, the receiver sets pressure, place, and duration. The giver follows and does not wander or add a place.
4. Stop, a lifted hand, or moving away retires it. If it finishes, one word: comfort, affection, neutral, or stop. Then swap.

Four is a ceiling. Read the words back. Welcomes expire when you get up.

This stays nonsexual. Do not ask why, and do not lobby a not tonight. A mark is not consent past this list, and it ends with the evening.

You may describe instead of touching, and skip the explanation. A pass on the swap is a decline.